CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which line from a poem would best support the claim that words can heal? 1

(a) The wind blew hard.
(b) He ran fast.
(c) The road was long.
(d) A gentle word mended what the day had torn.

2. Which reading of a poem on self-belief is least supported? 1

(a) Belief matters **(b)** Starting is hard
(c) Avoid all challenges **(d)** Courage grows by acting

3. Choose the correct participle: ___ her fear, she stepped onto the track. 1

(a) Overcoming **(b)** Overcame **(c)** Overcomes **(d)** Overcome by

4. Choose the correct reported form: Leela said, 'Let us hear her first.' 1

(a) Leela told us hear her.
(b) Leela suggested that they should hear her first.
(c) Leela said let us hear her first.
(d) Leela asked let hear.

5. Identify the participle phrase: 'Carrying a heavy bag, he crossed the dunes.' 1

(a) the dunes **(b)** a heavy
(c) he crossed **(d)** Carrying a heavy bag

6. The word 'tenacity' is closest in meaning to: 1

(a) joy **(b)** persistence **(c)** weakness **(d)** speed

7. The phrase 'ability beyond disability' implies: 1

(a) fear **(b)** rejection of a deficit view
(c) pity **(d)** denial of difficulty

8. A critic says the play makes Nabin too easy to convince. A fair reply is that: 1

(a) his own history and the performance prepare the change
(b) he is a villain
(c) the play ignores him
(d) he never changes

9. A critic says the chapter romanticises hardship. A fair reply is that it also: 1

(a) highlights real need for support and recognition
(b) ignores the desert
(c) is a comedy
(d) praises only comfort

10. The phrase 'count the cost' contains an economic metaphor which suggests: 1

(a) dreams must be 'paid for' with effort **(b)** dreams are bought
(c) dreams are cheap **(d)** dreams have no price

11. A reading of the poem as 'sentimental' may be countered by noting its: 1

(a) plain narrative and restraint **(b)** humour
(c) loud language **(d)** violence

12. A poem praising music could be criticised as 'idealised' if it: 1

(a) is about nature **(b)** uses rhyme
(c) is too long **(d)** ignores any drawbacks of music

13. The paradox 'a few words can say more than a thousand' means: 1

(a) long speeches are best
(b) brief, sincere words can carry great meaning
(c) numbers matter
(d) silence is empty

14. The paradox 'to fail is to learn' is consistent with the unit because: 1

(a) failure is shameful
(b) failure is rare
(c) failure gives experience that builds success
(d) failure is good in itself

15. Which sentence has a relative clause? 1

(a) The runner fell.
(b) Fallen, he cried.
(c) The runner who fell was helped by others.
(d) He fell and cried.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why might silence also be a form of communication? 2

17. How does a direct style suit a motivational message? 2

18. How does the interview avoid pity and promote respect? 2

19. How does Leela's questioning technique make Nabin confront his own bias? 2

20. How does the chapter challenge the idea that important work is always glamorous? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Discuss how the chapter uses understatement to create respect. 3

22. How does the letter anticipate and answer possible objections to dreaming? 3

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23. Explain how the poem employs ordinary words to achieve emotional depth. 3

24. Explain the importance of mutual respect in resolving conflicts, using the play. 3

OR

Analyse the poem's treatment of power. 3

25. Analyse how metaphor can be used in a motivational poem. 3

OR

Write a sentence using 'whereas' to contrast Dr Malik and the poem's runners. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Analyse the structure of the interview and how it builds towards its message. 5

OR

Analyse the characters of Shruti and Nabin as foils to each other. 5

27. Critically analyse the portrayal of Khetaram. 5

OR

Critically analyse the mother's approach to mentoring. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

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